

Journal Not in Control 2-23-25

Meeting date: February 24, 2025, 07:30 am

Overview

- The meeting focused on a personal reflection regarding interpersonal dynamics, particularly within the context of the speaker's relationship with their partner. The speaker expressed feelings of frustration over perceived controlling behaviors and a lack of mutual consideration during shared activities, such as watching movies and planning outings. They grappled with internal judgments and the challenge of balancing personal needs with relationship expectations. The discussion also touched on broader themes of responsibility, intuitive awareness, and the importance of taking action to address disturbances in relationships. Ultimately, the speaker recognized the need to let go of certain frustrations, distinguishing between letting go out of wisdom versus despair, while acknowledging their own responsibilities and external pressures.

Outline

- **Outline of Transcript**
- **Chapter 1: Introduction to Journal Update**
 - **Timestamp:** 00:02 - 00:10
 - General introduction to the journal update.
- **Chapter 2: Internal Conflict and Reflection**
 - **Timestamp:** 00:10 - 01:05
 - Discussion of internal judgments and the practice of independent thinking.
- **Chapter 3: The Nature of the Mind**
 - **Timestamp:** 01:05 - 02:11
 - Exploration of the mind as a sense sphere and the complexities of separating consciousness from the mind.
- **Chapter 4: Personal Relationships and Responsibilities**
 - **Timestamp:** 02:11 - 02:36
 - Reflection on personal responsibility versus instinctual responsibility.
- **Chapter 5: Observations of Partner's Behavior**

- **Timestamp: 02:36 - 04:32**
- Specific examples of frustrations with partner's movie choices and behaviors during shared activities.
- **Chapter 6: Feelings of Control and Pressure**
 - **Timestamp: 04:32 - 07:28**
 - Discussion of feelings of control in the relationship and the pressure of external demands.
- **Chapter 7: Coping with External Stressors**
 - **Timestamp: 07:28 - 09:18**
 - Acknowledgment of the challenges of managing external pressures while maintaining personal well-being.
- **Chapter 8: The Importance of Action and Letting Go**
 - **Timestamp: 09:18 - 11:07**
 - Reflection on the necessity of taking action to alleviate disturbances and the distinction between letting go out of wisdom versus despair.
- **Chapter 9: Conclusion and Personal Duties**
 - **Timestamp: 11:07 - 11:58**
 - Closing thoughts on personal responsibilities and the need to address practical matters.

Notes

- **General Journal Update (00:02 - 11:58)**
 - **Struggle with Internal Judgments:** The speaker reflects on their internal judgments and the challenge of maintaining an independent view from external influences.
 - **Questioning Buddhist Principles:** The speaker questions the Buddhist principle of the mind as a sense sphere, noting the complexity of separating consciousness from the mind.
 - **Observations of Spousal Behavior:** The speaker discusses frustrations with their partner's behavior during movie watching, feeling that their time is undervalued.
 - **Recurring Issues:** The speaker highlights a pattern where their partner dictates movie

choices, leading to feelings of annoyance and frustration.

- **Control in the Relationship:** The speaker expresses feelings of being controlled by their partner's requests, particularly regarding shared activities like walks and movie watching.
- **Pressure from External Factors:** The speaker notes that external pressures exacerbate feelings of being overwhelmed and controlled within the relationship.
- **Need for Action:** The speaker reflects on the importance of taking action when disturbed by interpersonal issues, emphasizing that taking action can lead to feeling better.
- **Letting Go:** The speaker concludes with the idea that letting go can stem from wisdom or despair, indicating a need to find a balance between the two.
- **Personal Responsibilities:** The speaker acknowledges their own duties and responsibilities, indicating a sense of urgency to address personal matters.

Action items

- Action Items
- Responsible Person: Unassigned
 - Get the car to the shop. (Timestamp: 11:20)

Andy's 1:1 conversation

- Outline
- I. Updates
 - 00:02 - 01:05: Introduction to the general journal update and internal judgments.
 - 01:05 - 02:11: Reflection on the relationship between mind, consciousness, and intuitive awareness.
 - 02:11 - 04:47: Observations about interactions with spouse regarding movie choices and feelings of frustration.
 - 04:47 - 06:30: Discussion on the dynamics of watching YouTube and feeling controlled in the relationship.

- **06:30 - 09:18:** Feelings of pressure and control in daily interactions, including driving and scheduling activities.
- **II. Action Items**
 - **09:18 - 10:06:** Consider taking action when something bothers you to alleviate feelings of frustration.
 - **10:06 - 10:40:** Reflect on the importance of letting go of things that cannot be changed and distinguishing between letting go out of wisdom versus despair.
- **III. Next Steps**
 - **10:40 - 11:35:** Plan to address personal responsibilities, including getting the car to the shop and managing daily duties.
 - **11:35 - 11:58:** Acknowledge the need to balance personal feelings with external responsibilities and interactions.

Transcript of a conversation

- **Outline**
- **Updates**
 - **00:02 - 01:05:** Introduction to the general journal update; internal judgments and the practice of independent thinking.
 - **01:05 - 02:11:** Discussion on the separation of the mind from higher consciousness; questioning Buddhist principles.
 - **02:11 - 04:47:** Observations on interpersonal dynamics with spouse regarding movie watching habits and feelings of frustration.
- **Action Items**
 - **04:47 - 05:49:** Address feelings of annoyance regarding perceived one-sidedness in interactions; need for mutual understanding.

- **05:49 - 07:27:** Acknowledge feelings of being controlled and pressured; consider ways to communicate these feelings to spouse.
- **07:27 - 09:36:** Reflect on the impact of external pressures on personal well-being; identify actions to alleviate stress.
- **Next Steps**
 - **09:36 - 10:40:** Explore the concept of letting go; differentiate between letting go out of wisdom versus despair.
 - **10:40 - 11:35:** Plan to address personal duties and responsibilities, including car maintenance; prioritize self-care amidst external obligations.